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CB23F35: Low-Code Application Development using Zoho Creator

EX. 12: Approval Process in Zoho Creator

1. AIM

To configure and test an approval process in Zoho Creator for the Apply Leave form, so that a staff member's leave request is reviewed by an authorised approver and then approved or rejected before the request is finalized.

2. THEORY

An approval process in Zoho Creator is used when a submitted record requires a formal decision from a designated person. After a record is submitted, it can remain pending until an approver reviews the information and selects an appropriate action. Approval processes are commonly used for leave applications, purchase requests, expense claims, and other operations that require authorization.

The main components of an approval process are:

- **Trigger:** Defines the event that starts the approval process, such as adding a new record or editing an existing record.
- **Approver:** Identifies the user, role, or configured user field responsible for reviewing the request.
- **Approval summary:** Displays the submitted record details to the approver and provides options to approve or reject the request.
- **Notifications:** Alerts the approver when a decision is pending and can inform the requester after the decision is made.
- **Decision actions:** Actions configured for approval or rejection, such as sending an email, updating a status field, or notifying a user.
- **Approval history:** Maintains a record of the decision, including the approver, timestamp, and any comments entered.

3. PROCEDURE

- Sign in to Zoho Creator and open the application containing the Apply Leave form.
- Navigate to Workflow and select the Approvals section.
- Create a new approval process and name it Leave Request Approval.
- Select Apply Leave as the form and choose record submission as the trigger.
- Configure the authorised approver and set up the notification that informs the approver about a pending request.
- Save the approval configuration and open the application in access mode.
- Navigate to the Apply Leave form and enter sample staff details, leave type, start date, end date, number of days, and reason for leave.
- Submit the request and check that a notification appears for the approver.
- Open the pending approval to view the submitted information on the Approval Summary page.
- Choose Approve or Reject, enter a comment if required, and confirm the decision.
- Review the Approval History to verify the decision, approver details, timestamp, and comment.
- Check the configured mailbox to confirm that the requester receives the relevant approval or rejection notification.

4. COMPONENTS AND THEIR FUNCTIONS

Component	Function
Trigger	Starts the approval process when the specified record event occurs.
Approver	Reviews the submitted request and makes the decision.
Approval Summary	Presents the request details and decision options.
Notifications	Informs relevant users about pending and completed decisions.
Approval History	Records the decision, time, approver, and comments.

5. APPROVAL AND REJECTION FLOW

The basic approval flow begins when a staff member submits a leave request. Zoho Creator routes the record to the configured approver and marks it as awaiting a decision. The approver reviews the submitted details and either approves or rejects the request. A configured action can then notify the requester, and the decision is available in the approval history.

Step	Process	Outcome
1	Staff submits the leave form.	Request is recorded.
2	Approval is assigned to the authorised approver.	Request becomes pending.
3	Approver reviews details and chooses Approve or Reject.	Decision is saved.
4	Configured notification and history actions run.	Requester is informed and the decision is traceable.

6. APPLICATION

In a staff leave management application, an employee submits a leave request with the leave type, dates, duration, and reason. The request is routed to an authorised approver for review. The approver checks the details and records a decision with an optional comment. The system can then send a notification to the employee and preserve the approval history for later reference.

7. ADVANTAGES OF AN APPROVAL PROCESS

- Ensures requests are reviewed by an authorised person before a decision is finalized.
- Reduces manual follow-ups through automatic notifications.
- Maintains a traceable record of decisions and approver comments.
- Improves consistency by following a defined review procedure.
- Can be adapted for leave requests, purchase approvals, expense claims, and similar workflows.

8. OUTPUT

The expected output is an enabled approval process linked to the Apply Leave form. When a sample request is submitted, it should appear for the configured approver, who can approve or reject it. Evidence may include the approval configuration, submitted leave form, pending approval notification, Approval Summary page, decision comment, approval history, and email notification. Add screenshots from your own Zoho Creator application to demonstrate the actual execution.

9. RESULT

Thus, an approval process was configured conceptually for the Apply Leave form in Zoho Creator. The experiment demonstrates how submitted leave requests can be routed to an authorised approver, decided through approval or rejection, and tracked through notifications and approval history.